Beacon Digest -- 2026-10-18

Security

ConnectWise Suspends Cloud Backup After Attackers Compromise Microsoft 365 Tenants

Source: The Hacker News

> ConnectWise on Saturday said it has disabled seven ConnectWise application identities as it continues its investigation into an incident in which unknown threat actors obtained unauthorized access to the application identities and compromised Microsoft 365 tenants. The disabled identities are listed...

MALFEX npm Package 'imgdecode' Hides Shellcode Loader in Windows Native Addon

Source: The Hacker News

> Cybersecurity researchers have discovered a malicious npm package that's part of a recently disclosed software supply chain attack campaign dubbed MALFEX. The package, named "imgdecode," was uploaded to the package registry on September 30, 2026, by a user named "malfexteste8." It has been downloade...

General Tech

DeepSeek search and fetch – $0.75 per 1000 successful requests

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://api-docs.deepseek.com/guides/search/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50138531 Points: 164 # Comments: 70

A Princeton PhD Applied to 2,300 Jobs. He Still Can't Get One

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.wsj.com/lifestyle/careers/labor-market-freeze-phd-graduate-f8e17d7c Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50138462 Points: 38 # Comments: 38

Matthew Prince on why Cloudflare offers a free version and always will (2016)

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://webmasters.stackexchange.com/questions/88659/how-can-cloudflare-offer-a-free-cdn-with-unlimited-bandwidth/88685#88685 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50138087 Points: 91 # Comments: 59

A Mole Infiltrated the Highest Ranks of American Militias (2025)

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.propublica.org/article/ap3-oath-keepers-militia-mole Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50138044 Points: 87 # Comments: 18

Notes on the Complex Roots of Unity

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://eli.thegreenplace.net/2026/notes-on-the-complex-roots-of-unity/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50138002 Points: 22 # Comments: 3

Show HN: Sphinx – A hook that quizzes you on your AI's code before shipping

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> FOSS, Basically it plugs into your existing coding agent workflow and every time you push to prod it'll throw up a questionnaire that checks if you understand how the code you're pushing works. Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50137950 Points: 115 # Comments: 30

How the Elizabeth Holmes documentary “You Can See Everything” is deceiving

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.readtheprofile.com/p/elizabeth-holmes-documentary-you-can-see-everything Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50137620 Points: 130 # Comments: 127

NY announces game ownership bill requiring ownership rather than licensing

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/video-games/new-york-rep-announces-game-ownership-bill-that-would-require-consumer-ownership-rather-than-sale-of-licenses-would-also-require-publishers-to-keep-the-game-functional-after-support-ends Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50136536...

Codex Desktop continuously generates Crashpad pending dumps

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://github.com/openai/codex/issues/25921 Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50133231 Points: 129 # Comments: 47

Gold is now the top U.S. export

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.numismaticnews.net/gold-now-top-u-s-export Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50132870 Points: 327 # Comments: 179

Pele – Mermaid diagrams as themeable SVG

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://pele.run/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50132193 Points: 426 # Comments: 38

Solar surpasses nuclear power globally for first time

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.pv-magazine.com/2026/09/29/solar-surpasses-nuclear-power-globally-for-first-time/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50131256 Points: 602 # Comments: 376

Making chicken transparent using Dorito dust

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://chillphysicsenjoyer.substack.com/p/making-chicken-transparent-using Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50131213 Points: 301 # Comments: 81

Show HN: Esp32sim – Run ESP32 firmware in the browser

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Hi HN, I've been working on esp32sim, an open-source ESP32 emulator that runs in the browser. The fun part of the demo is that there is no ESP32 involved — the firmware is executing in the emulator. The goal is to make ESP32 software easier to experiment with, test and simulate without always needin...

Show HN: High-quality duck audio synthesizer

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://celphase.github.io/duck-pond/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50131006 Points: 132 # Comments: 29

Interactive Linear Programming in the Browser

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://lpviz.net/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50130379 Points: 29 # Comments: 0

Propagation of Sound in Strongly Viscous Liquids (1966) [pdf]

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://jetp.ras.ru/cgi-bin/dn/e_023_05_0893.pdf Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50126457 Points: 7 # Comments: 1

Dam removals are bringing fish back across the northeastern United States

Source: Hacker News (Top 20)

> Article URL: https://www.smithsonianmag.com/science-nature/dam-removals-are-bringing-fish-back-across-the-northeastern-united-states-striking-down-one-tiny-barrier-at-a-time-180989679/ Comments URL: https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=50126312 Points: 272 # Comments: 65